a. Natural Water Pollution

1. It is caused by the adverse weather conditions.
2. Storm water bringing surface wastes, silt, vegetable matter, minerals, bacteria, etc., with it thereby polluting water.
3. Storm reservoir containing sand, silt and hence polluting the water.
4. Properties of ground surface through which the water travels.
5. Natural water pollution is occasional and its consequential effects are little.

b. Artificial water pollution

It is caused as a result of man-made activities as below

1. Wastes from the human habitation such as human excreta, urine, washing, kitchen waste and laundry waste.
2. Wastes from industries such as grease, oil, explosives and radioactive substances, chemicals, alkalis, acids, lime, starch, highly odorous substances, coal washings, vegetable oils and soap, paper pulp, etc.
3. Agricultural wastes like backyard drainage, pesticides, manure, etc.
4. Infiltration of surrounding substances into the water distribution pipes through cracks or leaky joints.





Effects of Water Pollution

1. The self purification property of rivers is lost due to excessive organic load.
2. The fish and other aquatic life are destroyed due to de-oxygenation.
3. Insanitation is caused by suspended solids.
4. The pathogenic bacterias enter into the water due to the presence of organic matter.
5. Foul smelling due to the decomposed floating matter
6. Sporadic outbreak of waterborne diseases due to the consumption of polluted water by communities.
7. River pollution makes the water aesthetically unfit for bathing and other recreational purposes.
8. It is very costly and difficult to treat polluted water.

Preventive measures to control water pollution

The preventive measures to be taken effectively to control water pollution are as follows

1. The people should be educated to avoid water pollution.
2. The industrial wastes should be treated well before discharging them into natural water bodies.

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